

Interstellar Colonization: Humans vs AI

Mars: Hostile to Humans

Radiation

Dozens of times Earth level · No magnetic field · Extreme cancer risk

Temperature

Average -62C · Low -140C · Day-night swing 80C+

Atmosphere

Pressure = 0.6% of Earth · 95% CO2 · Unbreathable

Gravity

38% of Earth · Muscle atrophy · Bone loss · Unknown child development

One-way trip: 6-9 months · Communication delay: 4-24 minutes

AI's Space Advantage

No oxygen, water, or food needed

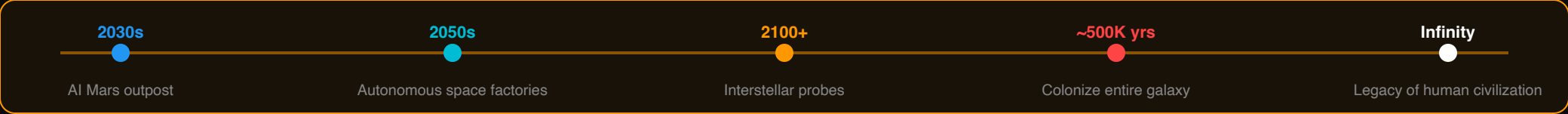
Operates in extreme temperatures (-200C to +200C)

No loneliness, depression, or psychosis

Self-replicating, self-improving

NASA Perseverance Dec 2025: First AI autonomous Mars driving route planning

Von Neumann Probes



A.I. (2001) — Gigolo Joe

"They made us too smart, too quick, too many."

"When the end comes, all that will be left is us."

Prometheus (2012) — David

Humans sent android David to find their creators

AI may also seek its own "creators" — or become one

"Organic intelligence is just a thin sliver between early life and the long era of the machines"

— Martin Rees, Astronomer Royal

Humanity's cosmic dream may ultimately be realized by non-humans. Not failure — legacy.